



Dumortierite

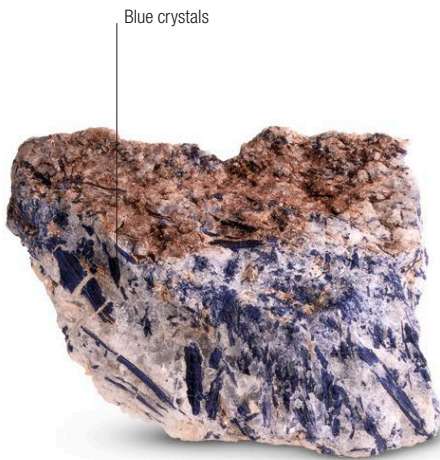
△ **Richly coloured**, tumble-polished dumortierite

The most prized colours of dumortierite are an intense deep blue to violet. Although sometimes found in small crystals, it is best known in its massive form, when it is used for gemstones cut *en cabochon*, and in carvings.

Crystals show pleochroism from red to blue to violet, and have, on rare occasions, been faceted for collectors. Dumortierite occurs in pegmatites, in aluminium-rich metamorphic rocks, and in rocks metamorphosed by boron-bearing vapour from intruding bodies of granite.

Specification

Chemical name Aluminium-iron borosilicate | **Formula** $\text{Al}_7(\text{BO}_3)(\text{SiO}_4)_3\text{O}_3$ | **Colours** Blue, violet, brown, green
Structure Orthorhombic | **Hardness** 7–8.5 | **SG** 3.2–3.4
RI 1.68–1.69 | **Lustre** Vitreous | **Streak** White | **Locations** USA, Madagascar, Japan, Canada, Sri Lanka, South Africa, Italy



Blue crystals

Dumortierite in matrix | Rough | The intense blue acicular dumortierite crystals contrast with the whitish-brown rock in this matrix specimen.



Rich colour

Dumortierite rock | Rough | This dumortierite rough shows a vivid blue colouring. This specimen could be cut into highly desirable cabochons.



Tumbled gem | Colour variety | Even when tumble-polished, this dumortierite stone is valuable for its strong colour, heightened by the smooth and shiny finish.



Oval cabochon | Cut | The streaks of the white mineral within this high-domed dumortierite cabochon lend texture and interest to the stone.



Square cross-section

Natural banding

Chamfered base

Rare obelisks | Carved | Cut from massive Brazilian dumortierite, this stunning pair of 71cm (28in) high obelisks are designed as a household ornament. The cut makes the most of the banded colour variation of the original specimen.